

## Khalitya and Palitya

### Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To understand the concept of Khalitya and Palitya
- ⇒ To understand the Nidana Panchaka of Khalitya and Palitya mentioned in Ayurveda literatures
- ⇒ To understand the concept of Palitya
- ⇒ To understand the Nidana Panchaka of Palitya mentioned in Ayurveda literatures

### Khalitya

*Khalitya* is a disease involving scalp of an individual. This is identified by the absence of hairs in the scalp region. This disease is also called as *Indralupta*, *Rujya*. This disease can be either patchy i.e. involving a few areas of the scalp or diffuse i.e. involving whole scalp region.

तेजोऽनिलाद्यैः सह केशभूमिं दुग्ध्वाऽऽशु कुर्यात् खलति नरस्य।

Ca.Ci. – 26/132

- ⊗ As per *Charaka*, the disease *Khalitya* is manifested in an individual due to the vitiation of *Pitta* and *Vata*.
- ⊗ This vitiation is responsible for *Dagdhatta* or burning of scalp hairs. As a result, there will be falling of hairs from the scalp takes place.

रोमकूपानुगं पित्तं वातेन सह मूच्छितम्।

प्रच्यावयति रोमाणि ततः श्लेष्मा सशोणितः॥3 1॥

रुणद्धि रोमकूपांस्तु ततोऽन्येषामसंभवः।

तदिन्द्रलुप्तं खालित्यं रुज्येति च विभाव्यते॥3 2॥ Su.Ni. – 13/31-32

रोमकूपानुगं पित्तं वातेन सह मूच्छितमिति खालित्यं पुंसा- मेव न तु योषिताम्।

तथाच विदेहः, – ‘अत्यन्तसुकुमा- रांग्यो रजो दुष्टं स्रवन्ति च।

अव्यायामरता यस्मात् तस्मान्न खलतिः स्त्रियाम्॥3 1॥

Dalhana, Su.Ni. – 13/31,32

- ⊗ *Pitta* and *Vata* *Dosha* are going to get vitiated in the patients of *Khalitya*.
- ⊗ After vitiation, these *Dosha* move towards the *Romakupa* (root of hairs of scalp)
- ⊗ Hair fall occurs as a consequence to this change.

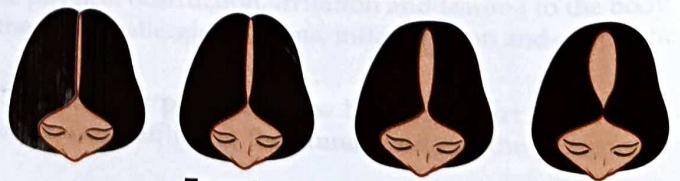
- ⊗ *Kapha* and *Rakta* are getting blocked in the region of *Romakupa*.
- ⊗ No new scalp hairs are produced and the person will remain scalp hair less and no new scalp hairs are seen.
- ⊗ This is also called as *Indralupta* and *Rujya*.
- ⊗ This disease is seen in males not in females.

### Alopecia

#### Male and female pattern baldness



Male-pattern baldness



Female-pattern baldness

Figure 239: Pratyatma Lakshana of Khalitya



- Alopecia is a dermatologic condition in which sudden or gradual loss of hair occurs on 1 or more areas of the body, most commonly the scalp.
- Hair loss can be acute or chronic in nature as a result of underlying inflammation, autoimmune processes, stressors, chemotherapy, or hairstyling practices.
- Alopecia can have substantial psychological consequences, having a negative impact on the quality of life in affected patients.
- The ability to both recognize and distinguish these condition holds great significance not only in providing adequate and timely treatment to improve outcomes but also meeting patient needs.
- There are three terms used in the context of alopecia.
- They are alopecia areata, alopecia totalis and alopecia universalis.

### Alopecia areata

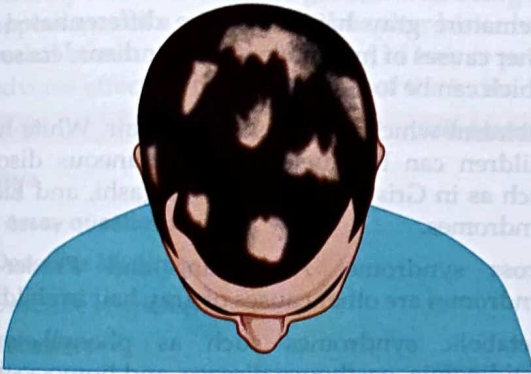


Figure 240: Alopecia areata

- This condition is associated with patchy hair loss from the scalp. Most of the occasions, the cause of this condition is psychological.

### Alopecia totalis

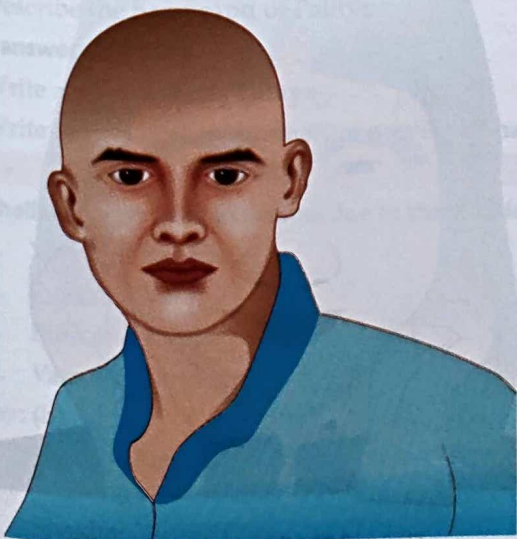


Figure 241: Alopecia totalis

- This condition is associated with complete hair loss from the scalp.

### Alopecia universalis

- This clinical condition is associated with complete hair loss over entire parts of the body including axilla, eyebrows, eyelashes, pubic region and scalp.

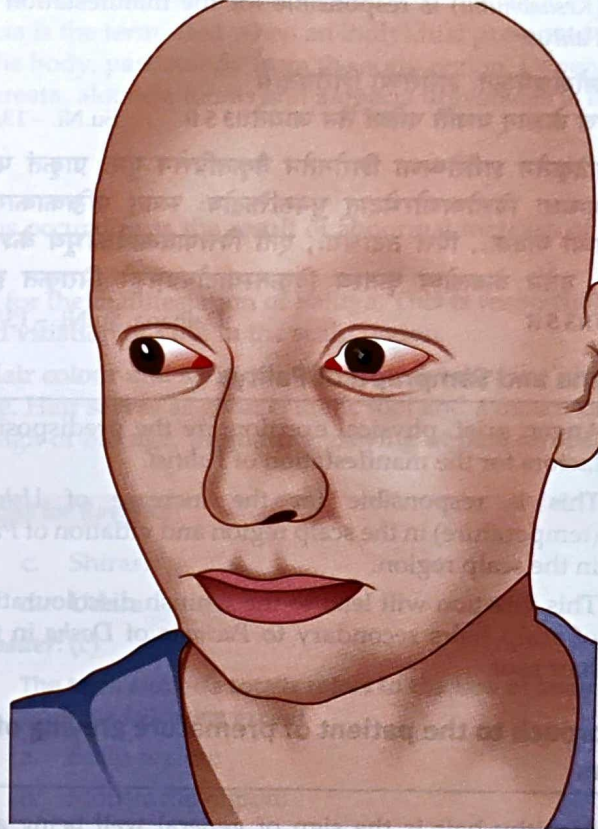


Figure 242: Alopecia universalis

### Palitya

#### Introduction

- Palitya is a disease of scalp region. This is characterised by greyish discolouration of scalp hairs in premature age.
- This disease is having the dominance of Pitta along with Vata Dosha.
- When this is occurring in the elderly individuals, this can be categorised under Kalaja category of Svabhavabala Pravritta Vikara of Adhidaivika Vikara.
- If the same is observed in the younger individuals, then such Vikara can be considered under Akalaja variety of Svabhavabala Pravritta Vikara of Adhidaivika Vikara.

तेजोऽनिलाद्यैः सह केशभूमिं दग्ध्वाऽऽशु कुर्यात् खलतिं नरस्य।

किंचित्तु दग्ध्वा पलितानि कुर्याद्भरिप्रभत्वं च शिरोरुहाणाम्॥ १३२ ॥



- Premature greying of scalp hair is being termed as *Palitya*.

This occurs due to abnormal increase of *Pitta Dosha* in the body.

- Usually, this happens due to normal ageing process.
- As per *Charaka*, partial burning of scalp region (*Keshabhumi*) is responsible for the manifestation of *Palitya*.

क्रोधशोकश्रमकृतः शरीरोष्मा शिरोगतः॥

पित्तं च केशान् पचति पलितं तेन जायते॥३५॥ Su.Ni. – 13/35

क्रोधादिकृतेन शरीरोष्मणा शिरोगतेन वैकृतपित्तेन पुनः प्राकृतं पलितं; अन्यथा पित्तोष्मणोरभेदात् पुनरुक्तिदोषः स्यात् पञ्जिकाकारस्तु शरीरोष्मा पावकः, पित्तं तदाश्रयः, एतौ पित्तपावकावेकीभूय केशान् पचेत्, एतेन केवलोष्म कृतस्य विकृतस्यादोषप्रसङ्गो निराकृत इति मन्यते॥३५॥

Dalhana, Su.Ni. – 13/35

### Nidana and Samprapti of Palitya

- Anger, grief, physical exertion are the predisposing factors for the manifestation of *Palitya*.
- This is responsible for the increase of *Ushma* (temperature) in the scalp region and vitiation of *Pitta* in the scalp region.
- This vitiation will lead to the whitish discolouration of scalp hairs secondary to *Pachana* of *Dosha* in the hair root.

### Approach to the patient of premature greying of hairs

- Healthy hair is the sign of general well being and youth.

Hair colour and style can significantly alter the physical appearance of a person and thus alter his or her body image.

Hair serves as great esthetic tool and a means of non verbal communication.

- Greying of hair is perceived as a sign of old age, premature greying of hair can bear an adverse effect on the self-esteem of the individual.
- Hair pigmentation is one of the most unique features in humans ranging from black, brown, and blonde to red.

The color of human hair is due to pigment melanin produced by melanocytes which are neural crest derivatives.

Human hair follicles contain two types of melanin as follows: eumelanin and pheomelanin.

- Severe mental stress, vitamin B12 deficiency, decreased thyroid hormones, antimalarials, smoking, protein energy malnutrition are some of the causes

noted by the researchers on the cause of premature greying of hairs.

Greying can also occur with premature aging disorders such as progeria and pangeria.

### Presentation of greying

- The rule of thumb states that by the age of 50 years, 50% of the population would have 50% of their hair turned gray.
- In men, graying first occurs in the temples and sideburns.
- It spreads to the vertex and rest of the scalp involving the occiput the last.
- In women, graying is first noticed at the boundaries of the scalp.

### Differential diagnosis of premature greying hair

- Premature gray hair has to be differentiated from other causes of hypomelanotic hair disorders some of which can be localized.
- Albinism which can cause white hair. White hair in children can be due to neurocutaneous disorders such as in Griscelli, Chediak–Higashi, and Elejalde syndromes.
- Cross syndrome, Angelman, and Prader–Willi syndromes are other causes of gray hair in childhood.
- Metabolic syndromes such as phenylketonuria, histidinemia, oasthouse disease, and homocystinuria can cause light hair.
- Vitiligo is an important cause of localized white hair called poliosis.
- Poliosis is also seen in Piebaldism, Waardenburg syndrome, Woolf syndrome, and tuberous sclerosis.



Figure 243 : Patient of albinism



## Key points of the chapter

**Khalitya**

तेजोऽनिलाद्यैः सह केशभूमिं दुग्धवोशु कुर्यात् खलति नरस्य।

Ca.Ci. – 26/132

- Khalitya is the disease afflicts the scalp of the individual. This is caused by the dominance of the Pitta associated with the vitiation of the Vata Dosha. It is also termed as Indralupta, Rujya.
- Pratyatma Lakshana of this disease is patchy or complete loss of hair from the scalp region.
- When one considers from the western point of view, alopecia is the term used when an individual presented with sudden or gradual loss of hairs from one or more areas of the body, particularly from the scalp region. Depending upon the distribution of hair loss from the body, alopecia areata, alopecia totalis and alopecia universalis is being used.

**Palitya**

- Premature greying of scalp hair is termed as Palitya. This is occurring as the result of abnormal increase of Pitta Dosha in the body.
- Anger, grief, physical exertion are the predisposing factors for the manifestation of Palitya. This is responsible for the increase of Ushma (temperature) in the scalp region and vitiation of Pitta in the scalp region.
- Healthy hair is the sign of general well being and youth. Hair colour and style can significantly alter the physical appearance of a person and thus alter his or her body image. Hair serves as great esthetic tool and a means of non verbal communication. Greying of hair is perceived as a sign of old age, premature greying of hair can bear an adverse effect on the self-esteem of the individual.

## Self-Assessment: Questions for Reviews

**Khalitya****Short essay questions**

- Describe *Khalitya*
- Describe *Alopecia*

**Short answers**

- Write a short note on *Khalitya*
- Write a short note on *alopecia*.

**Palitya****Short essay questions**

- Describe *Palitya*
- Describe the Samprapti of *Palitya*

**Short answer questions**

- Write a short note on *Palitya*
- Write a short note on premature greying of hairs

**MCQs**

1. *Khalitya* occurs in an individual due to the vitiation of
  - a. Vata and Kapha;
  - b. Pitta and Vata;
  - c. Pitta and Kapha;
  - d. Vata, Pitta and Kapha

Answer: (b)

2. As per Ayurveda textbooks, *Khalitya* occurs in which of the following parts of the body?

- a. Shakha;
- b. Sandhi;

- c. Shiras;
- d. Udara

Answer: (c)

3. The term *alopecia totalis* refers to the loss of body hairs from the following except

- a. Scalp region;
- b. Moustache region;
- c. Beard region;
- d. Pubic region

Answer: (d)

4. The term *Indralupta* refers to

- a. Synonym of *Khalitya*;
- b. A type of Marma;
- c. A type of Jalouka;
- d. A type of disease affecting Jalouka

Answer: (a)

5. Which of the following is related to the disease *Khalitya* except

- a. Rujya – synonym of *Khalitya*;
- b. *Indralupta* – a synonym of *Khalitya*;
- c. *Indramada* – synonym of *Khalitya*;
- d. All of the above are synonyms of *Khalitya*

Answer: (c)

6. Dosha dominance observed in *Palitya* is

- a. Pitta;

- b. Pitta and Vata;
- c. Pitta and Kapha;
- d. Vata, Pitta and Kapha

Answer: (b)

**7. Which part of the body is affected in Palitya?**

- a. Whole body;
- b. Mukha;
- c. Shiras;
- d. Udara and Uras

Answer: (c)

**8. The black colour of the hair is due to the presence of**

- a. Melanin;
- b. Cobalamin;
- c. Albumin;
- d. Heparin

Answer: (a)

**9. As per Sushruta, this disease is included in**

- a. Kushtha;
- b. Visarpa;
- c. Kshudra Roga;
- d. Paliroga

Answer: (c)

**10. Palitya (premature greying) at 30 years of age is included in .....type of Vikara.**

- a. Adhyatmika;
- b. Adhibhautika;
- c. Adhidaivika;
- d. All of the above

Answer: (c)

**Chapter resources**

**Khalitya**

- ✱ Charaka Samhita Chikitsa Sthana 26th chapter
- ✱ Sushruta Samhita Nidana Sthana 13th chapter
- ✱ <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/34059240/> how to approach the patient of alopecia
- ✱ [www.msmanuals.com](http://www.msmanuals.com), [www.medicalnewstoday.com](http://www.medicalnewstoday.com)
- ✱ [www.practicalhealthcoach.uk](http://www.practicalhealthcoach.uk), [www.livingforeverything.com](http://www.livingforeverything.com)

**Palitya**

- ✱ Charaka Samhita Chikitsa Sthana 26<sup>th</sup> chapter
- ✱ Sushruta Samhita Nidana Sthana 13<sup>th</sup> chapter
- ✱ <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC6290285/> Premature greying of hair: review and updates
- ✱ [www.healthline.com](http://www.healthline.com)

\*\*\*